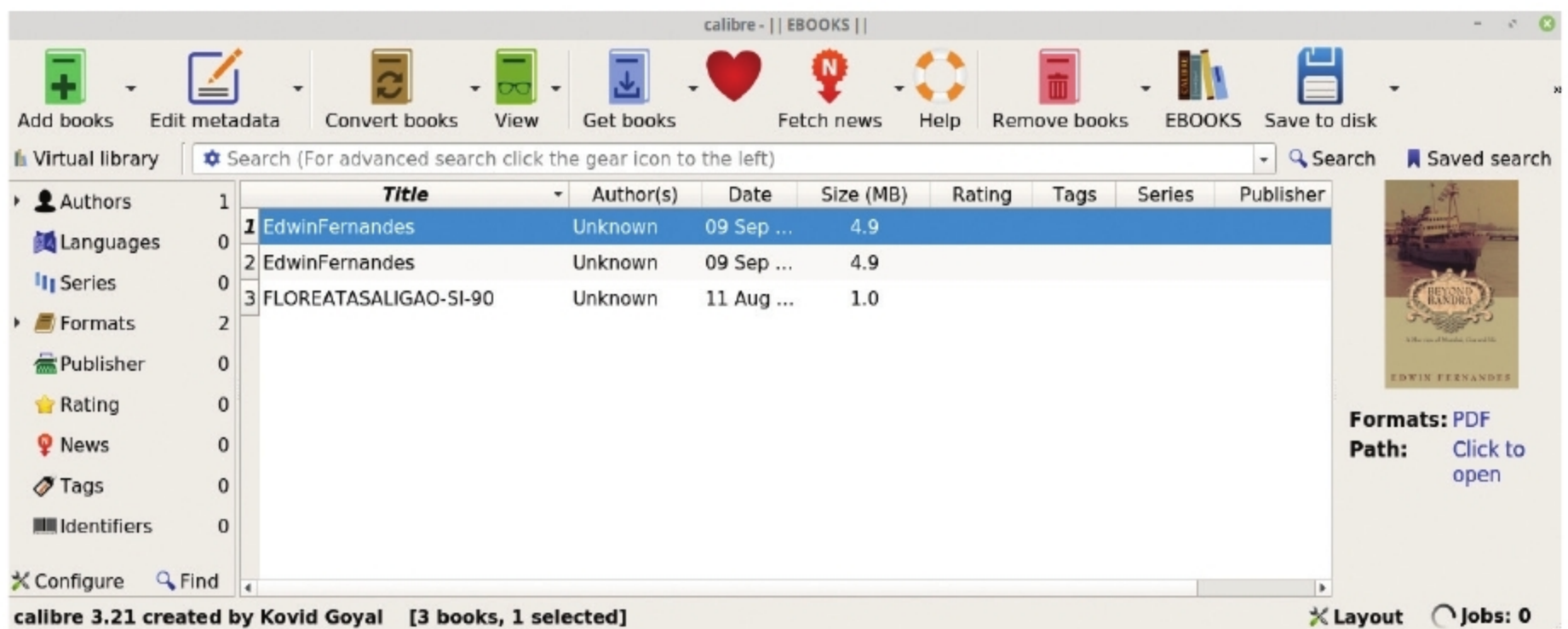




Calibre 2019

comprehensive tool for the management of digital texts, allowing you to do whatever you could possibly imagine with your e-book library."

E-books are digital books, consisting of texts and images. They can be delivered to you immediately on purchase. India is still to significantly pick up on e-book reading, but this is seen as one possible technology of the future.

calibre is written in Python, JavaScript, C++ and C. It works on GNU/Linux, Windows and the macOS operating systems. Its current stable version is 4.2 [1], released on October 18, 2019. The software's size is around 60MB.

By now, this e-book reader has diverse apps associated with it — Calibre Cloud, Calibre Sync, Calibre-go (all free of charge); and Calibre Cloud Pro, Calibre Companion, Calibre Library (all paid). CalibreBox comes with both free and paid versions.

Goyal acknowledges that reading is very important to him and "one of my goals has always been to prevent either the fragmentation or the monopolisation of the e-book market by entities that care solely for short term goals." Wonder what the Amazons of the world think of this Indian's approach.

As the calibre community continues to grow, driven by book lovers for book lovers, hopefully it will always present an alternative for people who love to read e-books and want to be in control of their own digital libraries, Goyal adds.

I asked him whether he feels enough Indians contribute to FOSS creation. "No," Goyal says. "India has a very limited presence in open source. The main reason for this is probably because most Indians who create software simply do it to make money, and not for the love of the subject. I'm sure that will change with time as Indian society as a whole gets more affluent," he adds.

calibre's evolution is entirely user driven, says Goyal, so new features come about as they are requested for, by the community. He adds: "My

immediate plans are to revamp certain internals of calibre to deal with changes in the underlying tech stacks."

When asked for a bio-data, Goyal tells me without irony, "I don't have a CV, I'm afraid, as I have never wanted to be employed. In brief, I graduated from Caltech with a PhD in Quantum Information Theory and have been working full time on calibre ever since (about 12 years now)." By way of background, Goyal went to Jamnabai Narsee School, did junior college at D.G. Ruparel and his undergrad at St Xavier's in Mumbai.

He adds: "I'm not very involved with FOSS movements, I just write FOSS software." A pity... India's young people could sure do with more role models.

Looking forward to more Kovid Goyals anyway.... **END** 🐧

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By: Frederick Noronha

The author is an independent journalist, publisher and has written on FOSS for almost two decades.